

Poetry Study





About the Course

Continuing in their poetry studies, students review a wide variety of poetic forms, learn how they have evolved over the centuries, and practice writing their own poems.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 9



Placement & Combining Tips

Prerequisite: Grade 8 Poetry Study or a working knowledge of poetic forms and terminology.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Poetry Study: Grade 9 2 times/week 15 min	The Making of a Poem

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

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The Making of a Poem



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

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How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

The Villanelle

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

This book introduces several poetic forms. Many of you will already know. However, some will be new, and there are still more that time won't allow us to cover. The anthology takes us further into the history of how those forms developed over the centuries, each new generation of poets dialoguing with those in the past. Along the way, you will read many different examples of each form, and you'll write your own poems as well.

→ READ

- p.xiii "This book" - "single poetic form."
- p.3-7 "Overview", "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and "The History of the Form"

→ NARRATE

- Jot down a few ideas from your reading.
- Read "The House on the Hill" by Edwin Arlington Robinson on p.9-10. Then look at p.5, "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and see if you can identify each of the poetic features listed in Robinson's poem. You may want to highlight, underline, or color-code the different features you find to help you notice and remember.

• COMPOSITION ACTIVITY

Over the year, you'll create your own reference book for the various poetic forms you study. The purpose is for you to have a quick guide that makes sense to you and is easy to pull up or keep on hand as you read individual poems. Start by creating your own "At-a-Glance" for the Villanelle. Here are a few of the possibilities:

- Copy the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" into a designated space in a notebook or a document on a device where you can easily find and reference it in the future. Add any additional notes for yourself that you'd like.
- Draw an illustration or create an infographic in Canva (or similar design software) showing the form more visually.
- Create a PowerPoint and create your own Villanelle At-a-Glance for the first slide (using text and/or visuals).
- Something else! Get creative!

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Reading Villanelles

Materials: The Making of a Poem, poetry notebook (opt.)

→ INTRO

Refresh your memory with the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" on p.5 and read the following villanelles aloud. Think about the following questions as you read. You may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking.

- What words strike you?
- What lines sound particularly odd?
- What reactions do you have as you read?
- Do all these poets follow the "rules" for villanelles, or do they bend them a bit? Playing with rules is part of the poet's business.

Naturalist Jack Laws encourages us to view nature by asking ourselves, "What do I notice?", "What do I wonder?", and "What does this remind me of?" We can ask these same questions of stories and poems as well. Read these poems actively! Again, you may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking as you read the next poems in this lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.11-12 "The Waking," "One Art," and "Do Not Go Gentle into That Good Night"
- p.14 "By the Sound"

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Term 1

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

More Villanelles

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ

p.18 "Villanelle for the Middle of the Night"

p.19-20 "Close-up of a Villanelle"

∞ Article Link: Villanelle by Andrew Lang

∞ Article Link: A Dainty Thing's the Villanelle by W.E. Henley

→ DISCUSS

- Which of the villanelles that you've read is your favorite? Why?
- The villanelle has been called the "poetry of loss" because of the way the repeated lines can build an echo of sadness. However, as you previously read, the villanelle originated from lighter ballads and songs and has also been used for lighter and happier topics (several of the ones you read today). What topics do you think the villanelle fits best?

• COMPOSITION

Start writing your own villanelle. Refer to your At-a-Glance guide and the villanelles you have read as needed.

Reference: Making of a Poem

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 4

The Sestina

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem, copies of poems (opt.)

→ INTRO

You'll read a variety of sestinas over the next few lessons. Sestinas are a pretty complicated poetic form (they show the poet/singer's mastery!), so it's ok if it takes a bit of time to make sense of the patterns. You may want to print off some of the poems or mark them up in your book to help you notice the various features of the genre (along with your other thoughts).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-24 "The Sestina At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

→ READ

Read the poem aloud to better hear the words since it is from the 1500s and the spelling is not the same as today (Edmund Spenser is a famous English poet from that time).

p.25-26 "Ye wastefull woodes, bear witness of my woe"

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

Reading Sestinas

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook

→ INTRO

Read the following poems aloud once to simply enjoy the sound of the words and get the sense of the poem. Then read the poems again, looking more closely at the formal features of the poetry (pay special attention to the last words of each line, and watch the pattern). Finally, write questions or thoughts in your book or notebook.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.29 "Sestina: Of the Lady Pietra degli Scrovigni (translation; the original is written in Italian by Dante Alighieri, who wrote the Divine Comedy)

p.30-31 "Sestina"

→ CREATE

Start creating your own "Sestina At-a-Glance" page for your reference guide in your digital or physical medium of choice.

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Term 1

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

More Sestinas

Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook used in the previous lesson

→ CREATE

Take a few minutes to finish creating your "Sestina At-a-Glance" page in your reference guide.

→ READ

p.32-35 "Sestina," "Sestina of the Tramp-Royal," and "Sestina: Altaforte"

(Note that part of the context for "Altaforte" is the poet imagining what a man known for stirring up strife might say. The man is based on a character in Dante's longer epic poem, the Divine Comedy, who was put in hell for stirring up strife).

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

How would you describe the energy and emotion in each of the poems from today?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

Sestinas Continued

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.38-40 "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina" and "Nani"

∞ Article Link: Sestina by Elizabeth Bishop

- If you drew an illustration for each of these three poems, what would it be? Why?
- How do you imagine the speakers in "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina" and "Nani"? Who are they?
- How do you think the title and shape (literal shape and length of lines) relate to the words of the poem in "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina"?

• COMPOSITION

Start writing your own sestina. Refer to your At-a-Glance guide and the sestinas you have read as needed. Because sestinas are fairly long and the form is complicated, you may not be able to finish your poem during the allotted time. Try to write at least two stanzas during the lesson and finish the poem on your own time if you like.

Reference: Making of a Poem

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

The Pantoum

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-45 "The Pantoum At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," and "The Contemporary Context"

p.47 "Pantoum of the Great Depression"

p.49-51 "Pantoum" and "Grandmother's Song"

You'll notice that not all of the Pantoums follow the "rules," especially the rules for the rhyme scheme.

- How would you describe the effect of this form?
- Why do you think the poets chose to break the "rules"?
- Do you hear the "mesmerizing chain of echoes" in these poems?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

Writing a Pantoum

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ

∞ Article Link: I'm going to like it here (from Oscar and Hammerstein; a

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partial Pantoum)

→ WRITE

Write your own pantoum. Be sure to follow rule #3, but you can choose which of the other rules to keep or break as long as the poem still follows enough rules to be recognizable as a Pantoum.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

Introducing Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ INTRO

For the rest of the term and into next, we'll be focusing on sonnets and some particularly famous sonneteers such as Petrarch, Shakespeare, John Donne, George Herbert, and others.

→ CREATE

Spend 5-10 minutes creating an "at-a-glance" for a Pantoum for a reference guide.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.55-59 "The Sonnet At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

NOTE: In #3 on p.55, the authors have conflated (combined) a third sonnet form with the Petrarchan. Don't worry about the details, but you'll want to ignore #3 in your book and focus on the two most common rhyme schemes listed below.

- Petrarchan: octave rhyming abba abba, followed by a set usually rhyming cdcdcd or cdecde.
- Shakespearean sonnet: rhyme scheme abab cdcd efef gg

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 11

Petrarch's Life & Poetry

→ INTRO

As a literature scholar explains, "Sonnet" comes from an Italian word meaning 'little song,' and that from a Latin word meaning 'sound.' Keep this in mind as you read.

→ READ & DISCUSS

After reading a brief bio, start reading some of Petrarch's sonnets. Read them aloud.

∞ Article Link: Petrarch Bio

∞ Article Link: Petrarch's Sonnets, Sonnet I, VI, VIII, X, XII, and XV

- Look more closely at one or two sonnets. Look at both the Italian and English versions. Can you see the rhyme pattern?
- Count the lines and find where the octave ends and the sestet begins. Can you see the shift, sometimes called the "volta", in the poem's tone or argument? What is it?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 12

More Petrarch

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pick a few other Petrarchan sonnets from a different translation to read.

∞ Article Link: More Petrarch Sonnets

• COMPOSITION

Some have called Petrarch's Sonnets the 14th-century equivalent of pop songs today. Compare and contrast the two. Would you agree or disagree with this comparison?

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- Look more closely at Sonnet XII. Based on the other sonnets you've read by Petrarch, what do you think about his claim that his far-off love, Laura, "points [him] to heaven"?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

Shakespeare Wrote Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an "At-a-glance" page to your reference guide for the Petrarchan Sonnet. Refer to p.55 "Sonnet At-a-Glance" and Lesson 10. You can combine your section on the Petrarchan sonnet with a section on Shakespearean sonnets, like our book does, or make two separate sections. Time will be allotted in other lessons to work on the details for the Shakespearean sonnet.

→ READ

p.59 "Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?"

In addition to his famous plays, Shakespeare is known for his sonnets--so much so that his name designates the unique form of the sonnet that became popular in England in the 16th century. If you have time remaining, pick a few sonnets to read for the rest of the lesson.

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets

Suggested: 8, 19, 23, 29, 55, 65, 73, 104, and 116

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

More Shakespearean Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

Instead of an octave of eight lines and a set of six like the Petrarchan sonnet, Shakespearean sonnets have three quatrains (four lines each) and then a final rhyming couplet. You can see the rhyme scheme on p.55. Notice that each of the quatrains starts a new set of rhyming lines.

Pick a few new sonnets to enjoy today, and then spend several minutes observing one or two more closely (particularly their structure and rhymes).

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets

Suggested Sonnets: 8, 19, 23, 29, 55, 65, 73, 104, and 116

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 15

Sonnets 116 and 73

→ OBSERVE & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets

Look at Sonnets 73 and 116 more closely.

- How many different word pictures can you find in the poems?
- Which ones stick out to you the most?
- Are any confusing?
- What kinds of emotions or thoughts do the images evoke?
- Describe the tone of the poems.
- Notice the rhyme scheme of the poems. Do they follow the Shakespearean form laid out in The Making of a Poem, p.55?
- Explain the first four lines of Sonnet 116 in your own words. What is Shakespeare saying about the nature of love? Do you agree?

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

The questions and activities in this lesson can be completed orally, in a group discussion, in writing, or even through sketches or other forms. Students should use whatever medium will best allow them to engage more deeply with these sonnets.

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Shakespearean sonnets are often written in iambic pentameter, which is a cadence natural to English. Choose either Sonnet 73 or 116 and count the syllables of each line, then read the poem aloud and listen for the stressed syllables.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 16

Add to Your Reference Guide

Materials: your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an at-a-glance section on the Shakespearean Sonnet to your reference guide, referring back to sonnets you've read, these lessons, and your book as desired.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 17

John Donne's Holy Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

John Donne lived during Shakespeare's time and took the sonnet form in a new direction as he built upon the tradition of both Petrarch and (what was coming to be known as) the Shakespearean sonnet. He was a poet and a priest, and instead of the flowing (and sometimes tearful) love poetry of Petrarch or Shakespeare, some of Donne's best-known sonnets are addressed to God rather than to a woman and contain unexpected rhythms and images. Pick a few sonnets to read aloud today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

Suggested Sonnets: VII, X, XIV, XV, XIX

- How would you describe John Donne based on what you've read in these poems?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 18

More Donne

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Continue reading Donne's sonnets. Finish reading the suggested sonnets from the last lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

Suggested Sonnets: VII, X, XIV, XV, XIX

- What lines do you think are most interesting or striking?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Benjamin Britten set some of Donne's sonnets to music!

∞ Audio Link: Britten's Holy Sonnets

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 19

Sonnets VII and X

→ OBSERVE (ORALLY OR IN WRITING)

- What is the rhyme scheme of Sonnets VII and X? Note: think about the way the last two lines in Sonnet X might sound in a Shakespearean British accent.
- Count the syllables in each line of both sonnets and listen to the rhythm of the poems. What do you think the meter is? (answers in the Teacher Note in the next lesson)
- Based on what you know of Shakespearean & Petrarchan sonnets, which

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form would you say each of Donne's sonnets aligns with more closely? Why? Consider the rhyme scheme, the larger structure (octave+sestet versus three quatrains + couplet), and the content of the poem (where does the turn or "volta" happen in the poem's argument or theme?).

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 20

Sonnet XIV

→ INTRO

Sonnet XIV is one of Donne's most famous sonnets. We're going to spend a bit more time with it today. First, read the poem aloud and narrate, telling what you remember and notice about the images, meaning, or anything else about the poem. Then use the discussion activities to dive deeper.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets
Sonnet XIV

- Look at the "formal features" of the poem. What is the rhyme scheme, meter, or structure (Shakespearean or Petrarchan)?
- Why might someone argue the sonnet is Shakespearean in structure? What is the evidence for a Petrarchan structure?
- What kinds of images or comparisons does Donne use in the poem? What do you think of them?
- Notice how Donne breaks the normal flow of a sonnet's iambic pentameter rhythm in the first four lines. Can you hear the "knocking" that Donne creates with the sounds of the words themselves in the lines "knock, breath, shine," and "break, blowe, burn"? Master poets often break the "rules" of a poetic form to add to their poem's effect and meaning. Whenever something is "wrong" in a poem or a book by a skilled writer, it is an invitation to ponder why, most likely, the rule was broken to show the sense of the words visually or acoustically.
- What do you think of the poem's overall effect and ideas?

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE Notes/Answers for Lesson 19

Sonnet VII rhyme scheme:

abbaabbacddcdee. The meter is pretty consistently iambic pentameter (typical for sonnets).

Sonnet X rhyme scheme:

abbaabbacddcdee (the meter is mostly iambic pentameter with some inconsistencies, but it's hard to hear it all because we don't pronounce or stress words quite the same as Donne did).

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 21

Serious Sonnets?

📄 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Are you tired of sonnets? Sonnets are dense "little songs," packed with word-pictures that require us to pause and ponder. As you've seen, they are often written in praise of something or someone and can focus on weighty topics like aging, death, and love for God. And they've been around for hundreds of years now, so sometimes the words themselves are hard to understand! Maybe sonnets are your new favorite type of poem. But if they're not, hopefully you're gaining a little more appreciation for how complex they are and how much thought and talent went into each of them! Today, take a break from some of the harder, older sonnets we've been reading and enjoy more recent ones (some with lighter topics, too!).

→ READ & DISCUSS

Pick 2-3 to read and discuss.

p.61 "Composed Upon Westminster Bridge"

p.62 "Ozymandias"

p.65 "From the Dark Tower"

p.67-68 "A Game of Chess"

∞ Article Link: Funny Sonnets (read #1)

∞ Article Link: Poetry

★ TEACHER NOTE Notes/answers for lesson 20

The rhyming couplet at the end of the sonnet aligns with a typical Shakespearean structure, but the overall rhyme scheme and the shift in thought in the final six lines (notice how the sestet begins a new sentence and starts with the contrasting conjunction, "Yet.") align with a Petrarchan structure.

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→ DISCUSS

Sonnets are "little songs" and often love poems or poems in praise of a person, God, or something else. And they often present some sort of struggle or problem, and the resolution (remember the "volta" or turn?). If you were going to write a sonnet, what would it be about?

WEEK 11 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 22

Writing a Sonnet

□ Materials: your reference guide

→ WRITE

Begin writing your own sonnet. Keep your reference guide on hand. Here are a few tips to get started:

1. Choose a topic. Perhaps something from a book or something you've experienced. Funny or serious.
2. After you've chosen your topic, think of some different ways to describe it. You might write down "[your topic] is like _\" and try to fill in the blank to get your creative juices flowing.
3. Read and then write a few lines of iambic pentameter to get the rhythm in your head (you can write gibberish - the point is just to get the flow in your mind).
4. Now start putting it all together and write your sonnet. You may want to write a full 14 lines and then go back and change some of the words to get the meter right, adjust a metaphor, etc.

★ STUDENT NOTE

You may choose to continue working on their sonnet during composition time this week or just spend the lesson time working on it. The goal is not to have a finished "product" but to engage the sonnet form experientially and seek to communicate your own ideas through it.

WEEK 12 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

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Term 2

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 25

Introducing Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Storytelling is common in every culture, and before the invention of the printing press, songs, stories, and fables were passed on orally from culture to culture and through the generations. As they traveled, storytellers developed their versions of the tale, adding or adjusting the narrative, the tune, or the verses of the song. The ballad is one form of storytelling with a long tradition, and it became a particular poetic form in English.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-78 "The Ballad At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

- Do you know any ballads or ballad-like poems/songs (new or old)? Name them and tell why they fit into the ballad genre as described in your book.

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Learn more about the history of ballads in North America.

∞ Article Link: LOC Ballads

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 26

Reading Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-83 "The Cherry-tree Carol (early 1400s)," "Sir Patrick Spens," "The Wife of Usher's Well," and "My Boy Willie"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to a different version of the Wife of Usher's Well.

∞ Article Link: The Wife of Usher's Well

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 27

Historical Ballads

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Listen to a few more ballads. Although not all folk songs are ballads, older ballads almost always are folk songs (newer ballads were often composed as poems rather than songs). Listen to 3-4.

- ∞ Video Link: The Water of Tyne (1364)
- ∞ Video Link: There Were Three Ravens (published 1611)
- ∞ Video Link: Corpus Christi Carol (early 1500s)
- ∞ Video Link: Frog Went a Courting (first mentioned in 1548, though this version has evolved from then)
- ∞ Video Link: Scarborough Fair (mid 1600s)

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 28

Reflecting on Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ REFLECT

Orally or in writing, reflect for about 10 minutes on the ballads from the last two lessons (you may want to reread or rewatch a few). What are the similarities and differences you notice? If you were an alien who knew nothing about the world and all you had were these ballads, what would you think about our world? Describe it to a fellow alien.

→ CREATE

Add a "Ballad-at-a-Glance" section to your reference guide. Refer to p.73.

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Term 2

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 29

Recent Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

Enjoy these more recent ballads. Notice how the content is similar and/or different from the older ballads.

p.88-90 "Peter and John"

p.92-94 "Tale of Custard the Dragon"

p.94-98 "Riverbend Blues" and "Ballad of John Cable and Three Gentlemen"

∞ Video Link: Wreck of the Edmund Fitzgerald

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 30

Writing a Ballad

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Write your own ballad and read (or sing!) it to someone.

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 31

Blank Verse

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.101-105 "Blank Verse At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context," and Henry Howard's excerpt from the Aeneid.

- Read Henry Howard's lines aloud (assume they are iambic and read the stresses that way).

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 32

Older Examples of Blank Verse

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105-110 "What is beauty" - "of the whole"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Look for examples of blank verse in Shakespeare's plays!

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 33

More Recent Blank Verse

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.110-118 "Ulysses" - "Stanzas in Bloomsbury"

• COMPOSITION

Write a narration (or pick a previous narration to rewrite) in blank verse.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 34

Heroic Couplet

Materials: The Making of a Poem, reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an "at-a-glance" section for Blank Verse to your reference guide.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.121-123 "The Heroic Couplet At-a-Glance," and "The History of the Form"

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Term 2

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 35

Chaucer: The Beginning of Heroic Couplets

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Canterbury Tales, General Prologue

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 36

Reading Heroic Couplets

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.123-127 "from the Description of Cooke-ham" - "from the Vanity of Human Wishes"

- Use heroic couplets to narrate your impressions of one of the poems you read.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 37

More Heroic Couplets

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-130 "To S.M" - "From an Essay on Criticism"

→ CREATE

Add an at-a-glance page on heroic couplets to your reference guide.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 38

The Stanza

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

What comes to your mind at the word "stanza"?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.136-142 "The Stanza At-a-Glance," - "from The Faerie Queene" (be sure to read Chaucer and Spenser's poems aloud)

- Why do the authors argue that the stanza is the "opposite of blank verse"?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 39

George Herbert

📖 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

George Herbert was a master of using stanzas in a variety of different ways. He was also a sonneteer and a poet-priest, like John Donne, in the late 16th and early 17th century.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.143 "Easter Wings"

∞ Article Link: The Altar

∞ Article Link: The Pulley

∞ Article Link: Prayer (I)

∞ Article Link: Redemption

- Consider how George Herbert uses poetic features to show an aspect of

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Pay attention to the stanzas you're reading in Fierce Wars and Faithful Loves in your Poetry Reading lessons!

Also, consider incorporating some of Herbert's poetry into your devotional life.

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Term 2

the poem's meaning. For instance, in the poem "The Pulley", look at how the line, "rest in the bottom lay," is at the bottom of the stanza. What other examples can you find?

- Where is the "turn" or volta in Herbert's sonnet "Prayer (I)"?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 40

Reading Stanzas

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.143-147 "The Tyger," - "A Quoi Bon Dire"

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 41

More Stanzas

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.148-149 "The Tropics in New York" and "Night Song at Amalfi"
p.150-151 "Those Winter Sundays" and "Yes"

★ TEACHER NOTE
Sensitive Word in "Yes."

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 42

Materials: The Making of a Poem and your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add a stanza-at-a-glance section to your reference guide.

→ WRITE

Look/think back over the different types of stanzas you've seen. Then write a poem about something that you read about in school or experienced in life, choosing a particular way of using stanzas that will add meaning to your poem. Add a note at the end of your poem explaining why you used stanzas the way you did.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 43

Meter At-a-Glance

Materials: The Making of a Poem, reference guide (opt.)

→ READ

p.159-160 "Types of Meter" and "the Character of Different Types of Meter"

→ DISCUSS

The overview of the meter is a bit dense, so let's make it more concrete.

- Look back over poems in these lessons and jot down a few other poems or songs you know. Make a list with examples of accentual metered poems, syllabic metered poems, and accentual-syllabic metered poems.
- You may want to turn this section into a new part of your reference guide as well.
- Why might a poet choose to use one form versus another?

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP
If you find it hard to think of examples for the lesson assignment, here are a few to get you started.

Accentual: Beowulf; Ba Ba Black Sheep

Syllabic: Think of Haikus you've read

Accentual-syllabic: Many sonnets

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 44

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ READ

p.160

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Term 2

→ NARRATE

- Write your own examples for each of the "feet" described.
- These definitions lend themselves to visual representation. Create an infographic (by hand or digitally) describing the different "feet" in poetry to add to your reference guide.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 45

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Refer to p.160 and write a few lines about something from your books or life, and use iambs as the main meter throughout the poem. Then write a few lines about the same topic using trochees. How did it change the feel of the poem?

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You may find it helpful to review examples of iambic and trochaic lines before writing to get the rhythm in your head.

Iambic examples: many sonnets.
Trochaic example: Tyger Tyger by William Blake (p.143), especially the first two lines.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 46

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Refer to p.160 and write a few lines about something from your books or in your life, and use dactyls as the main meter throughout the poem. Then write a few lines about the same topic using anapests. How did it change the feel of the poem?

Bonus idea: If you want to challenge yourself, try adding a spondee into one of your poems as well.

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You may find it helpful to review examples of dactylic and anapestic lines before writing to get the rhythm in your head.

Dactylic example:
∞ **Article Link:** The Charge of the Light Brigade

Anapestic example:
∞ **Article Link:** The Destruction of Sennacherib

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 48

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

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Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 49

Shaping Forms

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Stop to narrate after reading each section.

p.165-171 "Overview" "The Elegy-Overview," "Lament for the Makaris"

- Discuss this quote: "If metrical forms are the architecture of poetry, then the shaping forms of ode, elegy, and pastoral are its environment" (p.165)

• TERMINOLOGY

"Timor Mortis conturbat me" is Latin for "The fear of death disturbs me."

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 50

Reading Elegies

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Orally or in writing, reflect for about 5 minutes on the role of the poet and poetry today. Is poetry a part of public or popular life? Where and when? What types of poetry do you hear most frequently?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.171-178 "If Ever Hapless Woman Had a Cause" - "Lycidas"

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 51

Here Follow Some Verses

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ RECAP

Describe an elegy.

→ INTRO

Anne Bradstreet is a famous American poet. She was a master of meter and form. We're spending today on a poem she wrote after her house burned down. Be sure to read the poem aloud.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.178-180 "Here Follows Some Verses"

- Discuss this poem using naturalist Jack Laws' questions: What do you notice about this poem (including formal features)? What does it make you wonder? What does it remind you of? Look up words you don't know. Underline lines that stick out to you. Write questions or reactions.

• COMPOSITION

Rewrite Anne Bradstreet's poem as a one-act play.

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 52

More Elegies

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.180-190 "Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard" - "In Memory of W.B. Yeats"

- Of what you read today, which poem or poet would you most like to learn more about? Why?

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Term 3

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 53

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

You do not have to read all the poems in this section. Pick ones that interest you most. Notice all the different structures and formal features (meter, rhyme, etc) that poets employ for these elegies.
p.191-206 "The Quaker in Nantucket" - "The Song"

- If you were to write an elegy, what would you write it about?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 54

Writing an Elegy

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Start writing your own elegy. Add a note on why you chose the particular "architecture" (meter, rhyme, etc.) for your poem.

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 55

The Pastoral

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.207-212 "The Passionate Shepherd to His Love" - "The Garden"

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 56

Reading Pastorals

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ RECAP

Orally or in writing, describe some of the key themes in a pastoral.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.213- 219 "To My Sister" - "Lying in a Hammock"

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 57

More Pastorals

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.223-226 "Fog" - "Smoke"

p.227-232 "From the Porch" - Tornadoes"

- Orally or in writing, discuss one of the poems you read. What stood out to you? What made you confused, intrigued, and/or shocked?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 58

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

This last pastoral we'll read is by a more recent poet, Mary Oliver, who has continued celebrating the beauty of nature.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.235 "The Black Walnut Tree"

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Term 3

- ∞ Article Link: Starlings in Winter
- ∞ Article Link: Invitation
- ∞ Article Link: The Summer Day

Would you consider these poems pastorals? Why or why not?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 59

Writing a Pastoral

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Begin writing your own pastoral and then read it to someone. Add a note about why you used the "architecture" (meter, rhyme, etc.) that you did.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 60

The Ode

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.240-246 "Overview" - "The Fire of Driftwood"

- Discuss how each of the poems you read fits the definition of an ode (or not).

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 61

Reading Odes

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.248-255 "The Paper Nautilus" - "Perhaps the World Ends Here"

Pick one poem to observe more closely.

- Discuss what you notice about the images, meter, and rhyme.
- Why do you think the authors of the anthology considered it an ode?
- What are some of the ideas you notice in the poem?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 62

Perhaps the World Ends Here

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ LISTEN

Let's spend a little more time with an ode you read last week.

Read p.254-255

∞ Video Link: Perhaps the World Ends Here

→ DISCUSS

Reflect on the images in the poem. Why does the "world begin at the kitchen table"? What does the kitchen table symbolize or mean to you?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 63

Writing an Ode

→ WRITE

Compose your own ode.

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Term 3

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 64

Open Forms

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.259 "Overview"

→ READ & DISCUSS

In addition to its identity as an "open form," Prufrock is a wonderful example of how poems require "associative thinking." All poems, but especially some like Prufrock, require you to approach them like a painting. Only after you have observed the whole can you start to think about the ideas and emotions it describes. As you read and listen to the poem, let the words roll over you and let your mind drift with them. Listen to the sounds of the lines, the images described (some of them startling!), and notice the emotions the poem evokes. Do you feel frustrated as you read? Perhaps the poem INTENDS to make you feel frustrated!

p.262 "The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock"

- What images most strike you? What lines are most confusing? If this poem were a color, what color would it be? Why?
- Have you felt any of the emotions the speaker describes? Maybe you, too, have felt like you were "pinned and wriggling on a wall" when someone spoke to you.
- If you were going to draw an illustration to accompany this poem, what would it be?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to the author read his own poem

∞ **Video Link:** The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock

• ILLUSTRATE

Draw or paint your own illustration of the poem!

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 65

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.266 "I, Too"

p.268 "Spring and All"

∞ Article Link: From an Atlas of the Difficult World

∞ Article Link: Caged Bird

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 66

Write your own open-form poem

→ WRITE

You get to pick the form! Write a poem about something from your books and/or life. Add a note explaining why you picked the structure/meter (or lack of it) that you did.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 67

Your Reference Guide

→ REVISE

Look back over the poetic architecture and environments you've studied over the year. Spend a few minutes looking over your reference book as well. Is there anything you want to add or revise?

→ READ

Reread a few of your favorite poems from over the year.

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Term 3

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 68

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

- Describe each poetic form in one sentence covered this year, without actually using its name. Write, record, or use voice-to-text to write your answers and edit as desired. You will refer to these in the next lesson.
- Now, describe each poetic form with one word.

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You will need a classmate, friend, or family member to complete the assignments in the next lessons, so plan accordingly!

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 69

Materials: Activity from Lesson 68

→ PREP

Make sure you have your list of words and list of sentences on hand!

→ SHARE

Give a friend, classmate, family member, or teacher the list of forms you have studied over the year (skip this step if you want to make this activity harder!). Then give them your list of words from the last lesson and see if they can guess which words describe which forms. If they struggle, share your one-sentence description of each of the forms and see how they do. Then explain why you chose the words and descriptions you did.

★ CLASSROOM TIP

If using these lessons in a classroom setting, students could complete the assignment with each other or as homework with a parent. Regardless, be sure to leave room for students to share and discuss their descriptions and words with each other as students will likely have different ways of describing the various poetic forms, even though themes and some similarities should also emerge.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 70

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ REVISE

Look back over the poems you wrote this year. Pick one and revise it. Now that you have had some time to read other things and let your poem rest, you may find you'd like to change words, fix the meter, etc.

→ SHARE

Of the poems you have read this year, read your favorite ones to a friend or family member. Tell why it is a favorite. As a bonus, read one of the poems YOU wrote this year!

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

Poetry Study: Grade 9

Examination

Term 1

- Scan or turn in one of your "at-a-glance" pages in your reference guide.
- The Making of a Poem: Write a few lines about a poem you read this term. Include the name and form of the poem in your description.

Term 2

- Scan or turn in one of your "at-a-glance" pages in your reference guide.
- The Making of a Poem: Briefly explain the history of one of the poetic forms you studied this term (Sonnet, Ballad, etc.)

Term 3

- The Making of a Poem: Scan or turn in your list of descriptions and words from lesson 68.
- The Making of a Poem: Write a few lines about a poem you read this term. Include the name and form of the poem in your description.